The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "Refuge of Many Sons"

Āryabahuputrapratisaranāmadhāraṇī · Toh 976 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་བ་ཆུང་པའོ་རྣ་ཆེ་ཅན་བ་ཏྲའི་གཟུངས།

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "Refuge of Many Sons," known in Sanskrit as the Ārya Bahuputra Pratisara Nāma Dhāraṇī, is a short scripture centered on a protective incantation taught by the Buddha. It opens at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Anāthapiṇḍada's park, where the householder Anāthapiṇḍada comes to the Blessed One in distress, having quarreled bitterly with King Prasenajit and been driven away. In response, the Buddha offers him a dhāraṇī as a means of protection and remedy for such conflict and misfortune. The work is Toh 976 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the collection of dhāraṇī texts, the class of scriptures devoted to sacred formulas recited for protection and blessing.

In the language of India: ārya bahu putra pratisara nāma dhāraṇī
In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "Refuge of Many Sons."

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time the householder Anāthapiṇḍada went to where the Blessed One was. When he arrived, he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and said this to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, today I have fallen into quarreling, disputing and exposing each other's faults with King Prasenajit, and I have been driven away. Blessed One, what should I do about this?"

When he had said this, the Blessed One spoke to the householder Anāthapiṇḍada: "Householder, for this reason you should hold this vidyā-mantra called Refuge of Many Sons. Recite it, read it, and master it completely:

tadyathā daḍe badaḍe upadaḍadaḍe upadaḍedaḍa gambhīri abartane nibartane dhahi dhahi abartani my sarbe śānakarmikānāṃ pratyanrikānāṃ pratyamotriṇāṃ cakṣumohānāṃ karomi śrotremohānāṃ karomi jihvāgrātāṃ karomi jamabhānāṃ stambhanāṃ mohānāṃ pramohāṇāṃ

"Householder, if anyone recites this dhāraṇī of the Refuge of Many Sons seven times over a red thread and ties it to one finger of the left hand, then poison,

weapons, sickness, epidemics and violent fevers will not harm that person's body. He will be able to answer all quarrels, fault-finding and disputes."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the householder Anāthapiṇḍada rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

This completes the noble dhāraṇī called "Refuge of Many Sons."

It was translated, edited and finalized by the Indian preceptors Jinamitra and Dānaśīla and the chief editor-translator, the monk Yeshé Dé.

Translator's Notes

• The Tibetan rendering of the title, "Refuge of Many Sons," corresponds to Sanskrit pratisara, which also means a protective amulet or cord. That sense matches the rite of tying a red thread. The verb rendered "driven away" is uncertain. It may instead mean that the conflict has broken out or become widespread.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.